Reflective Practice as a Window into Teaching as Inquiry

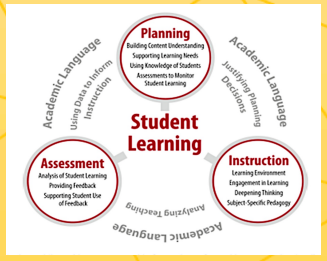
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Purpose

To describe the development of elementary pre-service teachers' reflection at three points during their professional literacy learning: Foundations, Methods, and Capstone courses, and to consider how instruction in a pre-service program might support or constrain the development of reflective practice.

Theoretical Framework

•Reflection is:
- •An ongoing, recursive process
- The analysis of connections between instructional planning, teaching, and assessment of student learning
- Illustrated by the edTPA's Cycle of Effective Teaching (Stanford Center for Assessment, Learning and Equity, 2013)



- Systematic reflection on instructional practices leads to understanding (Dewey, 1933; 1938; Hiebert, et al., 1996; Schön,1983; 1987).
- This is not an easy or natural process (Risko, Vukelich, & Roskos, 2009; Wade, Fauske, & Thompson, 2008).
- Instructor-guided practice and prompting can be beneficial (Kasten & Padak, 1997; York-Barr, Sommers, Ghere, & Montie, 2006).

Research Questions

1.What does advanced reflection look like at three different stages of professional learning?
2.What opportunities to reflect are we providing for teacher candidates and how are we supporting them as they grow in their ability to engage in advanced reflection?

Research Design

Qualitative Methods
- Inductive content analysis strategies (Cooley, 2013; Guba & Lincoln, 1994)
- Rubric categories as sensitizing concepts
- Research team members scored reflections individually and compared scores
- Additional team member scored randomly selected sample for each of 3 stages to develop categories

Inter-Rater Reliability
- 2 initial workshops-research team practiced scoring and aligned interpretations of rubric
- Inter-rater reliability was lower than desired in some categories (<80%)

Reflection Rubric

Adapted from Risko, Vukelich, and Roskos (2009)

	Emerging	Developing	Advanced
Identification of a Specific Aspect of the Lesson	Reflection includes surface or general descriptions of the lesson; reporting or retelling what occurred without any analysis of why students responded as they did	Description is more specific and includes some cause and effect analysis; student responses and performance are attributed to factors external to instruction	Description is specific and multiple explanations for the outcomes are considered; includes factors specific to the instructional decisions and behaviors of the teacher
Perspectives	Reflection is rooted in personal experience only	Reflection connects to one or two other sources or perspectives (e.g. other colleagues' experiences, research, theory, students' backgrounds, experiences, cultures) and considers how these might impact teaching and learning	Reflection connects to multiple sources or perspectives and considers how they might impact teaching and learning
Instructional Decisions	Reflection lists global, highly general adaptations for instruction	Majority of the adaptations are specific instructional techniques or strategies based on the responses and performance of students	All the adaptations are specific instructional techniques or strategies and are based on students' performance, knowledge of research and theory
Rationale for Instructional Decisions	Reflection provides little or no rationale for the adaptations suggested	The majority of the adaptations are supported with reasoned thinking about instruction; superficial connections are made to sources of evidence (e.g. student work, assessment data, research, theory)	All the adaptations are supported with evidence including the analysis of student work, assessment data, research, and/or theory
Commitment to Action	Reflection includes statements of action without specific steps for implementation or application	Reflection includes statements of action with general ideas of how the adaptation could be applied at some future date	Statements of action with specific steps for immediate application to instruction

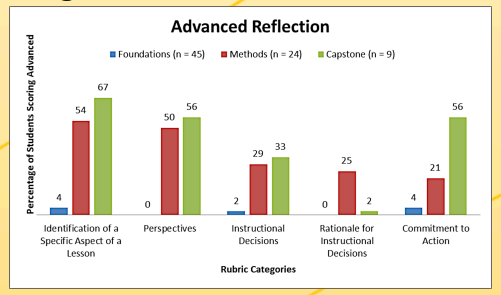
Participants and Site

•78 pre-service teachers at a large urban university in the Midwest
•Preparing to be elementary education teachers

Data Sources

Artifacts of Reflective Thinking for 3 courses:
•Foundations: Weekly written reflection
•Methods: Written reflections following each lesson
•Capstone: Written reflections following each lesson

Findings



Patterns of Significance
- Participants who scored advanced on all areas of the rubric made explicit connections between content objectives of their lessons and student engagement.
- Participants who scored advanced were able to analyze what went well, and what they could have done better or needed to change as it related to instruction.
- Advanced level reflections showcased a variety of perspectives (e.g., university mentor, cooperating teacher, peers, elementary students).
- Descriptors of advanced reflection for the instructional decision making category of the rubric are closely aligned with the content, objectives and frameworks of the three courses

Exemplars for the Instructional Decision Rubric Category

Instructional Decisions	Emerging	Developing	Advanced
	"Looking back at the video of this lesson I realized one thing I would change for next time is making sure to look at students' faces throughout the story more and check to make sure students are paying attention to the story and my questions. I think this will come more naturally as I teach more lessons, but I need to make it a goal for future lessons." (Methods)	"I will be able to understand how well students understood the assignment by reviewing their final copies of the graphic organizer once it is completed. This information will tell me what skills next to be reviewed and discussed for next time. I will look for student work samples that are good examples to help students for the next time we have to complete this organizer." (Capstone)	"This week with Cameron I incorporated some spelling activities (word work) based on the assessment analysis I did on his spelling test. His instructional level is in the derivational speller level, and I played a game with him where he had to eliminate and group the words with the same root." (Foundations)

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